

Key Moments in the History of the Internet



Early ARPANET network map

From the Cold War to the Web

The internet grew out of Cold War fears and the need to keep communications open during a possible nuclear attack. Over time, government research, networking experiments, and new software helped transform ARPANET into the foundation of the modern internet.

Year	Event	Importance
1957	Spuntnik I launched	The Soviet Union launched Sputnik, increasing U.S. fears during the Space Race.
1958	ARPA created	The United States created ARPA to support advanced research and defense projects.
1969	ARPANET established	ARPANET linked four universities and became the foundation of the modern internet.
1971	First email sent	Ray Tomlinson sent the first email and helped popularize the use of the @ symbol.
1972	TCP/IP developed	Vinton Cerf and Robert Kahn developed the communication protocols that made network connections more reliable.
1984	Internet is born	ARPANET split into MILNET and ARPANET, marking a major step in the birth of the Internet.

Year	Event	Importance
1989	World Wide Web invented	Tim Berners-Lee invented the World Wide Web.
1991	Web goes public	The World Wide Web became available to the public.

"The Internet has its origin in the fear of nuclear war."

ARPANET was important because it showed that distant computers could communicate across a shared network. It was designed to avoid a single point of failure, and many of its ideas later became part of the internet people use today.

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table {
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p {
  text-align: center;
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